



MATCHBOOK LEARNING
SCHOOLS OF INDIANA

CULTURE ENGINE

RESTORATIVE & COUNSELING HANDBOOK

RESTORATIVE TEAM & COUNSELING OPERATING MANUAL

WENDELL PHILLIPS SCHOOL 63 · 2026–27

A role-based handbook for the Restorative Team and Counselors. Roles, responsibilities, and operating routines are defined here so the culture system holds steady across people, schedules, and daily pressure. All positions are full-time to these roles.

PART 0

WHY WE EXIST

This handbook defines how the Restorative Team and Counselors protect the Culture Engine every day. It is written around roles so the work stays steady when faces, schedules, and daily pressure change. The work is practical and human: prevent what can be prevented, respond with regulation instead of reaction, repair harm when trust breaks, and return students to the community with dignity.

THE ONE TEST

There is one test for everything in these pages: does it prevent something that was preventable, or does it repair harm and restore a student to the community? If yes, it belongs in the Culture Engine. If not, it does not drive the work.

MISSION

Prevent the preventable. The team builds the conditions — regulation, relationship, belonging, and skill — that keep students in learning. When something breaks, the team repairs quickly, restores dignity, and gets students back where they belong.

Who this handbook governs: Restorative Team Members (each anchored to a grade band: K–2, 3–5, 6–8), Assistant Deans (response-system leads who supervise the restorative staff), and Counselors (K–4 and 5–8). The Director of Culture & Student Support provides oversight, culture architecture, Tier 3 decision-making, and final escalation; the Director's full scope lives in the leadership responsibilities review.

The practice this handbook protects: The team is organized around prevention and repair, not around a room or a reaction. Response is one function of the team, not its identity. The daily goal is to protect a prevention-first stance: the majority of time moves toward proactive connection, coaching, recognition, regulation, and repair, with response held clearly and efficiently when needed.

— THE COMMITMENTS WE HOLD (THE NON-NEGOTIABLES)

These are not bullet points to memorize. They are what we come back to when the day gets hard.

- **Prevention first, least-invasive.** Use the least intensive support that works. Removal is not the intervention; it is the rare last step, never the reflex.
- **Regulate before reason.** No teaching, reflection, or repair happens while a student is still in a threat state. Body first. Words second. Conversation and accountability come after regulation.

- **Protect the primary relationship.** Keep the student connected to their teacher and class whenever possible. The team supports that relationship; it does not replace it or become the place students are sent to be someone else's problem.
- **A regulated adult, first.** A dysregulated adult cannot sustainably regulate a child. Staff self-regulation is a job function, not a luxury — see Part 2.
- **Repair, do not exclude.** Accountability means repairing the specific impact of the behavior. A student's place in this community is never the thing taken away.
- **Authentic, never performed.** No forced apologies. A repair only counts when it is real; a coerced apology teaches compliance, not accountability.
- **Reach all students through systems.** Seven adults cannot relationally hold a whole school one-by-one. They build shared systems that every adult can run and use Houses to make belonging, recognition, and mentorship visible for every student.
- **Data is relational infrastructure.** Track connection and repair, not just incidents. An incident is not closed until the repair is completed and the loop is closed.
- **Equity by default.** Monitor who is referred, recognized, repaired, and excluded by group. Pause before any subjective referral and check for bias.

PART 1

THE ROLES

The team is one Culture Engine with four interlocking roles. Each role protects the same adult stance — regulation, dignity, consistency, relationship, repair, and equity — while holding a distinct lane in the system.

— RESTORATIVE TEAM MEMBER — GRADE-BAND ANCHOR (K–2, 3–5, 6–8)

PURPOSE Serve as the proactive culture anchor and lead co-regulator for an assigned grade band.

PRIMARY · PREVENTION Rotate through Morning Meetings to participate in proactive culture-building; run proactive circles; deliver the Lunch Culture Loop and lunch bunches; run the mentorship system

through Houses; drive recognition and celebration; build teacher capacity to regulate and run routines; conduct daily CICO check-ins; and maintain the band's Students-of-Concern / Connection-Team list.

SECONDARY · RESPONSE Run the Regulation Room for their band using the 3Rs sequence; provide Tap-In / Tap-Out support to teachers; and escort, scaffold, and confirm student re-entry and repair.

STOPS DOING Sitting in one room supervising all of K–8; operating as a disciplinary post; or becoming a holding space where students are separated from learning without repair.

REPORTS TO Assistant Dean.

— ASSISTANT DEAN — RESPONSE-SYSTEM LEAD (CO-EQUAL)

PURPOSE Own the response system and its consistency; lead, coach, and develop the restorative pod.

PRIMARY · PREVENTION Own the response protocol — referral threshold, room capacity, grade-band coordination, and equity of application; coach teachers on classroom management; hold Incident Command / Rapid Response; and supervise and grow the restorative staff.

SECONDARY · RESPONSE Serve as Regulation Room Lead in rotation and anchor proactive presence (e.g., a House).

STOPS DOING Being the default adult who "handles" students ad hoc; absorbing restorative conversations that belong with the band anchor or need to return to the teacher-student relationship.

REPORTS TO Head of School; escalates Tier 3 to the Director of Culture & Student Support.

— COUNSELOR — GRADE BAND (K–4, 5–8)

PURPOSE Clinical care, SEL system design, and family/community partnership.

PRIMARY · PREVENTION Contribute counseling and SEL-informed topic ideas to the Morning Meeting scope-and-sequence planning after staff are onboarded during the first 90 days; run clinical Tier 2/3 groups (e.g., Behavior Skills); build family and community systems; lead day-to-day attendance outreach (the 5–9 day range); and serve as Aspire liaison.

SECONDARY · RESPONSE Clinical lead for crisis, threat assessment, and suicide-ideation response; safety planning; and co-running high-need lunch bunches.

STOPS DOING Being pulled into general supervision or crowd control.

REPORTS TO Director of Culture & Student Support.

— DIRECTOR OF CULTURE & STUDENT SUPPORT — OVERSIGHT AND FINAL ESCALATION

The Director's full scope is defined in the leadership responsibilities review. Within this handbook, the Director holds the culture architecture, prevention system, Tier 3 decisions, Title IX and compliance, final escalation, and the weekly prevention-first cadence. **Handoffs are clear:** Assistant Deans escalate Tier 3 to the Director; Counselors route clinical, threat, and safety matters to the Director; Restorative staff surface emerging patterns to the Director through the Students-of-Concern review.

— HOW THE ROLES CONNECT (ESCALATION PATH)

- **Teacher needs support** → restorative band anchor responds — Tap-In (hold the class so the teacher can step to the hallway for a brief repair) or, when the moment requires a different adult first, Tap-Out (escort the student and run the process).
- **In-class reset is not enough** → student moves to the Regulation Room (Room Lead + band anchor) for the 3Rs.
- **Pattern or clinical need emerges** → Counselor (clinical lane) and Assistant Dean (system lane) coordinate so support is aligned, not fragmented.
- **Tier 3, safety, or compliance** → Director of Culture & Student Support.
- **Proactive belonging, recognition, and mentorship** → run continuously through Houses, not only through referrals.

— 1.5 · ROLE DAY-IN-THE-LIFE MAPS

The role descriptions above define ownership. The maps below translate ownership into staff-facing role cards and day-in-the-life rhythms. This is where the language becomes personal: your purpose, your primary work, what you stop doing, who you report to, and how the day lives in practice. These are role maps, not rigid scripts; safety, student need, and coverage may shift the exact order.

RESTORATIVE TEAM MEMBER — ROLE CARD

Your **purpose** is to serve as the proactive culture anchor and lead co-regulator for your grade band. Your **primary work** is prevention through Morning Meeting participation, proactive circles, Houses, recognition, CICO/DBRC, teacher capacity-building, and the Students-of-Concern / Connection-Team list. What you **stop doing** is sitting in one room as a K–8 holding space. You **report to** the Assistant Dean.

TIME / RHYTHM	PRIMARY STANCE AND WORK FOR THE ROLE
ARRIVAL / ENTRY	Join huddle; review Students-of-Concern, DBRC/CICO needs, and coverage shifts. Greet assigned grade-band students with regulation and belonging in mind.
MORNING MEETING BLOCK	Rotate through assigned rooms to participate in Morning Meeting, model proactive presence, help strengthen circle habits, and notice students who may need connection before the day escalates.
MORNING PROACTIVE BLOCK	Run proactive circles, push into rooms, support routines, complete CICO check-ins, mentor through Houses, and build teacher capacity without taking over the classroom.
LIVE RESPONSE AS NEEDED	Provide Tap-In / Tap-Out support; run the 3Rs in the Regulation Room for assigned-band students; escort and scaffold re-entry and repair.
LUNCH BLOCK	Run the Lunch Culture Loop, reflection lunch, lunch bunch, recognition, and grade-band presence. Lunch is prevention, not patrol.
AFTERNOON RESET / FOLLOW-THROUGH	Complete CICO/DBRC check-outs, confirm repair completion, update the Students-of-Concern / Connection-Team list, and prepare data for the close-the-loop review.
DEBRIEF	Share patterns, unfinished repairs, teacher support needs, equity concerns, and coverage notes with the Assistant Dean and team.

ASSISTANT DEAN — ROLE CARD

Your **purpose** is to protect response-system consistency and develop the restorative pod. Your **primary work** is keeping the safety spine clear, coaching adults, protecting referral thresholds, and ensuring the Regulation Room and Rapid Response systems work with dignity and equity. What you **stop doing** is becoming the default adult who handles every student ad hoc. You **report to** the Head of School and escalate Tier 3 to the Director of Culture & Student Support.

TIME / RHYTHM	PRIMARY STANCE AND WORK FOR THE ROLE
ARRIVAL / ENTRY	Lead or join huddle; confirm the safety spine, coverage card, absences, protected resets, and high-risk students or spaces.
MORNING SYSTEM CHECK	Hold Room Lead / Rapid Response coverage, monitor referral threshold consistency, and coach adults toward least-invasive support.
TEACHER SUPPORT	Coach classroom management, Warm Demander stance, Tap-In / Tap-Out decision-making, and repair expectations. The goal is adult capacity, not dean dependency.
INCIDENT COMMAND	Serve as Incident Commander or response lead when safety rises; keep roles clear so response is calm, fast, and documented.
LUNCH BLOCK	Protect the safety spine and upper-grade coverage while band anchors run prevention through the Lunch Culture Loop.
AFTERNOON SYSTEM WORK	Review Regulation Room flow, response consistency, equity patterns, repeated referrals, and Tier 2/Tier 3 escalation needs.
DEBRIEF	Confirm closed loops, unresolved incidents, staff coaching follow-up, and what needs to surface to the Director of Culture & Student Support.

COUNSELOR — ROLE CARD

Your **purpose** is to hold the clinical, SEL-informed, family/community, and safety-planning lane. Your **primary work** is targeted support, clinical groups, attendance outreach, Aspire liaison work, crisis response, and topic contributions to Morning Meeting planning after the first 90 days of staff onboarding. What you **stop doing** is being pulled into general supervision or crowd control. You **report to** the Director of Culture & Student Support.

TIME / RHYTHM	PRIMARY STANCE AND WORK FOR THE ROLE
ARRIVAL / ENTRY	Review risk check-ins, attendance concerns, clinical flags, family contact needs, Aspire items, and students needing a soft landing.
MORNING PREVENTION BLOCK	Support student regulation and belonging through a clinical lens; contribute to proactive planning while preserving the counseling lane.
MORNING MEETING PLANNING CONTRIBUTION	After staff are onboarded during the first 90 days, contribute topic ideas and SEL-informed guidance to the Morning Meeting scope and sequence. Counselors do not independently create the routine for others to execute.
CLINICAL GROUPS / TARGETED SUPPORT	Run Tier 2/3 groups such as Behavior Skills, support safety planning, conduct attendance outreach, and coordinate family/community partnership.
CRISIS LANE	Lead clinical response for crisis, threat assessment, suicide-ideation response, and safety planning while deans/restorative staff hold physical-safety response.

TIME / RHYTHM	PRIMARY STANCE AND WORK FOR THE ROLE
LUNCH / HIGH-NEED SUPPORT	Co-run high-need lunch bunches or support students whose regulation, peer relationships, or clinical needs require counselor presence.
DEBRIEF / DOCUMENTATION	Document clinical follow-up, family contact, safety planning, and patterns that need the Director's review.

DIRECTOR OF CULTURE & STUDENT SUPPORT — ROLE CARD

Your **purpose** is to hold the culture architecture, rights protection, final escalation, and prevention-first cadence. Your **primary work** is keeping the system coherent across prevention, response, repair, compliance, Tier 3, and adult coaching. What you **stop doing** is letting urgent response erase the prevention system. You coordinate with the Head of School and leadership team while holding final Culture & Student Support decisions in this handbook.

TIME / RHYTHM	PRIMARY STANCE AND WORK FOR THE ROLE
MORNING SYSTEM SCAN	Confirm that the Culture Engine is staffed, coverage risks are named, Tier 3/safety concerns are visible, and the team has a clear prevention-first focus.
ARCHITECTURE AND COACHING	Protect the culture design, coach Assistant Deans / Counselors / Restorative staff, and ensure adult practice stays aligned to dignity, regulation, repair, and equity.
ESCALATION AND COMPLIANCE	Own final escalation for Tier 3, safety, Title IX, compliance, manifestation determinations, and high-stakes family/community matters.
PREVENTION-FIRST CADENCE	Lead the weekly review of belonging, attendance, recognition reach, push-in/circle use, Students-of-Concern, repair completion, and equity patterns before response data dominates the conversation.
DECISION-MAKING	Make or approve decisions that change placement, supports, exclusionary-coded responses, or intensive plans. The Director protects rights and system integrity.
END-OF-DAY / WEEKLY LOOP	Review what closed, what remains open, what adults need, and what the system must adjust so the same preventable harm is less likely tomorrow.

PART 2

ADULT REGULATION FIRST (THE PREREQUISITE)

Restorative work begins with the adult. Before this team can help students regulate, repair, and re-enter the community, adults must be able to enter difficult moments with steadiness, dignity, and control over their own response. Adult regulation is therefore the first protocol in this handbook and a professional responsibility, not a personal wellness extra. Body first. Words second applies to adults, too.

— PROTECTED ADULT RESET

Every restorative and counseling staff member has a protected daily reset — a genuine, off-the-floor, duty-free period that protects adult restoration and readiness. The deeper purpose is not simply a break; it is to help adults return to students with calm, clarity, and the capacity to respond without carrying stress into the next interaction.

- **Protected.** The reset is scheduled, duty-free, and covered by the team through the coverage plan in Part 7. No one's protected reset doubles as supervision.
- **Staggered.** Resets rotate so coverage stays strong and a staff member is not off the floor during the moments when their anchor students most need them.
- **Non-negotiable.** Skipping restoration is not proof of dedication; over time, it weakens the adult capacity this work depends on. Leaders protect the reset because the Culture Engine requires regulated adults.

— COMPASSION FATIGUE & SECONDARY TRAUMATIC STRESS

This work carries secondary traumatic stress. Staff monitor their own levels through a brief, regular self-check, and the team builds in debrief and peer support so the load is shared rather than silently carried. The same staff also coach teachers to stay grounded — modeling and naming regulation for adults, not only for students.

- **Self-monitor.** Use a short weekly self-check on fatigue, dread, irritability, and depletion; flag early rather than waiting until capacity is gone.
- **Debrief.** A daily team touch-base and a standing check-in with the Director surface what is accumulating and adjust coverage before stress becomes harm.

- **Support the teachers' regulation too.** The team helps teachers stay grounded in their own window of tolerance — a regulated teacher prevents many referrals before they start.

— THE PERSONAL PAUSE (BEFORE RESPONDING)

Before answering a crisis call or stepping into a dysregulated space, the staff member takes a brief, deliberate pause to check their own body, breath, voice, and affect. The goal is to enter as a source of calm rather than another threat signal. Calm is contagious. So is alarm. The adult sets the nervous-system tone of the room.

- **Stop.** Pause at the threshold; do not enter mid-stride or mid-reaction.
- **Breathe.** Take two or three slow, exhale-led breaths (or a physiological sigh) to bring the body out of fight-or-flight.
- **Set the tone.** Soften face and voice to flat-calm; drop the shoulders; slow the pace.
- **Check.** Ask silently, 'Am I regulated enough to regulate them?' If not, send the regulated colleague in first — this is what cross-coverage is for.

WHY IT MATTERS

A student in a threat state reads the adult's body before the adult's words. An adult who arrives activated can confirm the threat and escalate it. An adult who arrives regulated gives the student a steady nervous-system signal to borrow until they can return to learning, reflection, and repair. Calm is contagious. So is alarm.

PART 3

THE PROACTIVE ENGINE

Prevention is where the Culture Engine does its deepest work. The team reaches students through systems every adult can run — Houses, Morning Meeting, recognition, CICO, Connection Teams, and the Lunch Culture Loop — so belonging is not left to chance or

limited to the students who generate referrals.

— 3.1 · CONNECTION TEAMS & THE STUDENTS-OF-CONCERN LIST

The team proactively builds and maintains a living list of students carrying sustained stress, repeated barriers, or emerging needs, so support arrives before behavior escalates rather than after.

- **Build the list.** Draw continuously from attendance, CICO trends, incident and repair data, and counselor/teacher referral. The list is updated weekly, not built once.
- **Deploy Connection Teams.** Every flagged student is assigned a sponsor / co-regulator — an adult with relational strength who is responsible for intentional connection. No high-need student should move through the system without an identified adult connection.
- **Review weekly.** The Students-of-Concern review feeds the weekly prevention-first cadence (Part 9) and routes patterns to the Director.
- **Equity check.** Scan the list for over- or under-representation by group; absence from the list can be as telling as presence.

— 3.2 · CHECK-IN / CHECK-OUT (CICO)

- **Morning check-in.** The band anchor reads each Tier 2/3 student's baseline window of tolerance before the cognitive load of the day begins and sets a simple, reachable goal.
- **Afternoon check-out.** Review the day, celebrate what worked, and set a positive target for tomorrow.
- **Monitor & move.** Progress is tracked against clear entry and exit criteria so students step up or fade down on data, not habit or adult frustration.

— 3.3 · MORNING MEETING PARTICIPATION & PROACTIVE CIRCLE-BUILDING

Morning Meeting is a shared adult culture routine, not a counseling-owned product or a restorative-only coaching block. Teachers lead the classroom routine; Restorative Team Members rotate through rooms to participate, model proactive presence, strengthen circle habits, and build belonging before students need response. Counselors do not own the Morning

Meeting program alone; after all staff are onboarded during the first 90 days, Counselors contribute topic ideas and SEL-informed guidance to the scope-and-sequence planning so the routine reflects student need, developmental readiness, and the school's culture priorities.

— 3.4 · HOUSES — THE DELIVERY VEHICLE FOR BELONGING

Houses make belonging visible, consistent, and shared. Each restorative staffer anchors House work for their band, and mentorship, recognition, and celebration all run through the House structure so every student has a place to be known and seen.

- **One owned recognition catalog.** LiveSchool, Cardinal Character, Student of the Week, and Friday Cypher are run as one coordinated catalog owned by the restorative team (with PBIS mechanics supported by the AP of Instruction) — not left to chance classroom by classroom.
- **Mentorship through Houses.** Every student has a House and a culture adult connected to it, so mentorship is a system of belonging, not seven separate personal calendars.

— 3.5 · THE LUNCH CULTURE LOOP

Lunch is treated as Tier 1 prevention, not patrol. The cafeteria screen carries a Regulate → Relate → Round arc, band-matched to the grade group eating, with reflection lunches and lunch bunches embedded in the coverage. A regulating, connecting lunch protects the afternoon by reducing the escalation a chaotic lunch can create. Coverage detail is in Part 7.

— 3.6 · BUILDING ADULT CAPACITY

Prevention is not only student-facing. A standing part of the team's week is rotating into classrooms, participating in Morning Meetings, supporting routines, and coaching regulation and circle-keeping through push-in support. The goal is not for the team to take over teacher routines; the goal is to build adult capacity so proactive culture lives in every room. This is the restorative team as a capacity-builder, not a fixing department.

LIVE CLASSROOM INTERVENTION: TAP-IN / TAP-OUT

When a student is dysregulated, the default is not removal. The first move protects the primary relationship and keeps the class learning. The restorative member's job is to make the teacher's intervention possible — and to take the student out only when the moment requires a different adult first.

WHEN TO CALL A teacher needs support with a dysregulated student and a brief, relational reset would help protect learning, dignity, and the teacher-student relationship.

Tap-In (the default — about 5 minutes): The restorative member pushes into the classroom and holds the class as a Warm Demander so the teacher can step into the hallway for a brief, private restorative conversation with the student — no more than about five minutes — and then both return. The teacher stays the intervener; the student stays connected to learning.

Tap-Out (the exception): The restorative member takes the student out of the learning environment and implements the restorative process (the 3Rs and repair). Tap-Out is used only when Tap-In is not in the best interest of the student or teacher — for example, the teacher is not regulated enough to engage in that moment, there is a safety concern, or the rupture makes a teacher-led repair unwise until the student is regulated. Tap-Out is the bridge into the Regulation Room.

- **Why the teacher leads in Tap-In.** The rupture is usually between teacher and student; the relationship heals through the teacher, not around them. The restorative member holds the room so that repair can happen with privacy and dignity.
- **Decision rule.** Try Tap-In first (teacher leads, student stays). Move to Tap-Out only when the teacher cannot or should not be the intervener in that moment; from Tap-Out the student is escorted to the Regulation Room for the 3Rs.
- **Skill requirement.** Every restorative staff member must be able to step into any K–8 room and run it as a Warm Demander. This is a named onboarding and training expectation.
- **Developmental note.** Younger students need more adult co-regulation and shorter cycles; older students need privacy, dignity, and a measure of autonomy in the de-escalation.

PART 5

THE REGULATION ROOM (THE 3RS)

When a student's dysregulation exceeds what an in-class reset can hold, they are escorted to the dedicated space — framed explicitly as the Regulation Room to emphasize positive skill-building, never as a punishment destination. It is one room with three zones, and the work inside it follows the order students need: regulate the body before relating, relate before reasoning.

THE SPACE One room, three zones — Somatic (Regulate), Relational (Relate), Cognitive (Reason). The Room Lead runs intake; each student is met by their grade-band anchor for the relational and cognitive work.

ENTRY · THE REFERRAL THRESHOLD A clear standard defines what earns a Regulation Room visit versus what stays classroom-managed, with a required bias pause before any subjective referral (defiance, disrespect, disruption). Referrals use observable language on a brief entry tool, not an incident-only form.

ROOM CAPACITY A set maximum of concurrent students protects the space from becoming a holding area. When the room is full, new arrivals are held in the Regulate zone and queued so the sequence remains intentional.

— THE 3RS SEQUENCE

- **Phase 1 — Regulate.** Welcome neutrally with minimal words, a flat tone, and an L-stance (a 90-degree angle, not face-on) to avoid triggering defense. Offer bottom-up sensory tools — water, weighted pads, deep breathing — and establish a physiological baseline. No talking, no demands until the body settles.
- **Phase 2 — Relate.** Once heart rate lowers and agitation settles, validate the student's emotional reality without validating the behavior. The adult connection creates felt safety so the student can begin to move from threat response toward reflection.
- **Phase 3 — Reason.** Only after the prefrontal cortex is back online, guide a restorative dialogue — who was harmed, what do they need, how do we make it right — and co-create a concrete matched-repair plan. This is the handoff into Part 6.

DOCUMENTATION Log the visit, duration, the tools and replacement behaviors that worked, and the repair plan. The data feeds the close-the-loop tracking in Part 9.

DEVELOPMENTAL CALIBRATION Durations and tools shift by band — younger students lean on sensory and adult co-regulation with shorter cycles; older students move sooner to cognitive reflection and more autonomy.

WHAT IT IS NOT

The Regulation Room is not ISS, not a holding pen, not a punishment, and not an untracked space. Removal is not the intervention. The sequence is.

PART 6

THE STUDENT REPAIR PROCESS & RE-ENTRY

The purpose of 'Reason' is real repair. The team scaffolds and arranges it; the student does it. Repair is matched to the specific impact, functions as the accountable consequence, counts only when authentic, and protects the student's membership in the community.

— THE STUDENT REPAIR ARC

- 1 Regulate.** Precondition — no repair while dysregulated (handoff from the 3Rs).
- 2 Reflect.** Name what happened, who or what was affected, and what need or missing skill drove the behavior.
- 3 Own it.** Name the impact and take accountability — without a coerced apology.
- 4 Repair the impact.** Do the matched action (the menu below). This is the heart of the process, not the reflection sheet.
- 5 Re-enter.** Follow the explicit path — correct → repair → rejoin — with a re-entry sentence or plan.

6 Follow through / close the loop. Complete missed work, practice the replacement behavior, and have the team confirm completion. A repeated pattern routes to a support plan, not heavier consequences.

— MATCHED REPAIR — STUDENT ACTION AND TEAM SUPPORT

HURT OR DISRESPECTED A PERSON

The student has a private restorative conversation, listens, offers an authentic apology only if it is real, and agrees on a next step.

TEAM Coach the dialogue and protect against a performed apology.

MADE A MESS, DAMAGED MATERIALS, DISRUPTED A SPACE

The student cleans up, restores, or repairs the space or materials.

TEAM Arrange the time and supplies and supervise.

INTERRUPTED LEARNING

The student redoes the routine, practices the replacement behavior, returns to task, and completes the missed work.

TEAM Scaffold the practice and coordinate the missed work with the teacher.

REFUSED, AVOIDED, OR ESCALATED

The student reflects after regulation, builds a replacement-skill plan, and creates a re-entry plan.

TEAM Run the reflection and co-build the skill plan.

HARMED A PEER RELATIONSHIP

The students engage in mediated problem-solving and a peer-repair routine, then agree how to move forward.

TEAM Facilitate the mediation.

BROKE TRUST WITH A TEACHER OR ADULT

The student and teacher hold a repair conversation and set a re-entry sentence or plan.

TEAM Set up and hold space for the teacher-led repair (consistent with Tap-Out).

DISRUPTED COMMUNITY OR COMMON SPACE

The student completes a community restoration or service connected to the specific impact.

TEAM Design the restoration task so it fits the harm.

REPEATED PATTERN

Repair plus a support plan, family communication, and a data review, with possible Tier 2/Tier 3 review.

TEAM Convene the support, loop the family, and escalate toward support rather than punishment.

DEVELOPMENTAL CALIBRATION K–2: concrete, short, adult-scaffolded (practice, clean up, simple repair). 3–5: guided reflection and mediation. 6–8: student-led agreements, community restoration, and more autonomy.

GUARDRAILS No forced apologies; repair must be completable and proportional to the impact; repair is never public shaming; and a repeated pattern always escalates to support, never only to a heavier consequence.

CLOSE THE LOOP

An incident is not closed until repair is completed and logged. Repair-conversation data is relational infrastructure: tracked, reviewed, and acted on.

PART 7

DAILY OPERATIONS & COVERAGE

SAMPLE COVERAGE MAP

This map shows the coverage logic the team uses each day. Final staff names and same-day adjustments are confirmed by leadership based on staffing, student need, and live coverage conditions. The team should review the map during onboarding so staff insight can strengthen flow without weakening the non-negotiable safety spine.

Coverage protects two things at once: student safety and adult readiness. It is weighted to the places and times where support is most needed. Early primary lunches are typically calmer and lower-conflict, so those blocks can run leaner. Upper-grade lunches receive heavier coverage because that is where conflict, peer dynamics, and transition pressure are more likely to concentrate.

The spine: Two posts are never empty — a Room Lead and a Rapid Response post, marked with ★. When a dean is at lunch, on a protected adult reset, or responding to an incident, a trained restorative staff member steps onto the open ★ post and some proactive work flexes temporarily. Safety does not flex. The Regulation Room does not go uncovered. Proactive work flexes only long enough to protect the spine, then is rebuilt.

— 7.1 • LEGEND

CODE	MEANING
D1, D2	Assistant Deans
R1	Restorative Team Member — K-2
R2	Restorative Team Member — 3-5
R3	Restorative Team Member — 6-8
C1	Counselor — K-4
C2	Counselor — 5-8
★	Always-on safety post — never empty
RR	Regulation Room
IC	Incident Command / Rapid Response
REC	Recess coverage
CAF	Cafeteria
Loop	Lunch Culture Loop + reflection/bunch
Lunch/Reset	Duty-free protected lunch and adult reset
MM	Morning Meeting participation / rotation

CODE	MEANING
CICO / DBRC	Check-In / Check-Out · Daily Behavior Report Card
Carside ♦	Brief family touchpoint at arrival or dismissal, as needed

— 7.2 · EXAMPLE DAILY COVERAGE MAP

TIME	D1	D2	R1 · K-2	R2 · 3-5	R3 · 6-8	C1 · K-4	C2 · 5-8
7:10-7:30	Huddle	Huddle	Prep	DBRC prep	DBRC prep	Watchlist	Watchlist
7:30-8:00	★ Entry safety · Carside ♦	★ Floor/RR · Carside ♦	Greet + DBRC	Greet + DBRC	Greet + DBRC	Risk check-ins	Risk check-ins
8:00-8:30	★ Floor/RR	★ Room Lead	MM rotate	MM rotate	MM rotate	SEL ideas / planning	SEL ideas / planning
8:30-10:15	★ RR / Incident	★ Room Lead	Circles + mentor	Push-in + recognition	Mentor	Clinical + on-call	Clinical + on-call
10:15 K + DREAM	★ RR / IC	★ Room + REC	CAF + Loop	REC support	Lunch/Reset	CAF support	REC support
10:50 · 1 + 2	★ RR / IC	Lunch/Reset	CAF + Loop	REC	★ Room + REC	CAF support	REC support
11:25 · 3 + 4	★ RR / IC	★ Room + REC	REC	CAF + Loop	REC	CAF support	Lunch/Reset
12:00 · 5 + 6	★ RR / IC	★ Room + REC	Lunch/Reset	CAF + Loop	CAF + Loop + REC	REC support	CAF support
12:35 · 7 + 8	★ RR / IC	★ Room + REC	REC support	REC support	CAF + Loop	Lunch/Reset	CAF support
1:10-2:10	★ RR / Incident	★ Room Lead	Circles + mentor	Lunch/Reset → proactive	Circles	Clinical + on-call	Clinical + on-call
2:10-2:45	★ Dismissal · Carside ♦	★ Dismissal/RR · Carside ♦	DBRC check-out	DBRC check-out	DBRC check-out	Risk check-out	Risk check-out
2:45-3:00	Debrief	Debrief	Data + debrief	Data + debrief	Data + debrief	Doc + debrief	Doc + debrief

— 7.3 · PROTECTED LUNCH / ADULT RESET ROTATION

Lunch is treated as a protected adult reset because adult restoration is part of adult readiness. One person is off the floor at a time, and each reset is scheduled on an off-band whenever possible so staff are not away when the students they anchor most need them.

STAFF MEMBER	PROTECTED LUNCH / RESET BLOCK
R3	10:15 — K + DREAM
D2	10:50 — 1st + 2nd

STAFF MEMBER	PROTECTED LUNCH / RESET BLOCK
C2	11:25 — 3rd + 4th
R1	12:00 — 5th + 6th
C1	12:35 — 7th + 8th
R2	1:10 — after upper-grade lunch
D1	1:40 — after the heaviest lunch coverage window

COVERAGE GUARDRAIL

Both deans are never off the floor at the same time. Both deans are present for every upper-grade lunch block where conflict and transition pressure are most likely to concentrate.

— 7.4 · CARSIDE CONFERENCES ♦

Carside Conferences are brief, responsive family touchpoints held during arrival and dismissal. They are not standing meetings and they do not replace formal family conferences, safety calls, or documented follow-up. They are used when a quick update, repair loop, clarification, or relationship-building touchpoint can be handled at the car without pulling a family into a longer meeting.

WHEN	WHO HOLDS IT	PURPOSE	GUARDRAIL
Arrival 7:15–8:00	D1 / D2 as coverage allows	Quick check-in, overnight context, readiness note, or family question	Keep it brief; document any follow-up needed
Dismissal 2:10–2:45	D1 / D2 as coverage allows	Same-day repair update, positive note, next-step reminder, or family clarification	Do not discuss sensitive details publicly or block dismissal flow

— 7.5 · LUNCH IS PREVENTION

LUNCH IS PREVENTION

The lunch blocks are not patrol. The band anchor runs the Lunch Culture Loop and reflection/bunch routines so the three-hour lunch window carries Tier 1 culture, regulation, belonging, and repair support rather than only supervision.

— 7.6 · COVERAGE BACKUP VISUALS

The daily schedule shows who is posted where. The backup visuals below show what happens when the day does not go according to schedule. The rule is simple: safety spine first, Regulation Room second, CICO/DBRC compressed but protected, proactive work flexed only when necessary and rebuilt afterward.

VISUAL 1 — FUNCTION BACKUP MATRIX

FUNCTION THAT MUST STAY COVERED	PRIMARY HOLDER	FIRST BACKUP	SECOND BACKUP	WHAT MAY FLEX FIRST
RAPID RESPONSE / INCIDENT COMMAND	Assistant Dean on ★ post	Other Assistant Dean	Trained Restorative Team Member	Proactive circles / recognition block
REGULATION ROOM LEAD	Assistant Dean / assigned Room Lead	Restorative band anchor	Next available trained restorative staff	Lunch bunch / proactive support
BAND RE-ENTRY & REPAIR	Restorative band anchor	Room Lead	Assistant Dean	Non-urgent mentoring block
CLINICAL CRISIS / THREAT / SAFETY	Band Counselor	Other Counselor	Director of Culture & Student Support	Clinical group rescheduled if safe
CICO / DBRC	Band anchor	Another restorative staff member	Assistant Dean checks essentials	Length compressed, not dropped

VISUAL 2 — IF / THEN COVERAGE FLOW

IF THIS HAPPENS...	THEN THE FIRST MOVE IS...	THEN THE BACKFILL IS...	WHAT STAYS PROTECTED
Student fight / physical safety issue	Rapid Response moves immediately; Dean/Director holds IC	Band anchor becomes acting floor; Room Lead holds RR	Safety spine, clinical lane, documentation

IF THIS HAPPENS...	THEN THE FIRST MOVE IS...	THEN THE BACKFILL IS...	WHAT STAYS PROTECTED
Regulation Room fills	Room Lead protects capacity and intake order	Band anchors help complete 3Rs and repair plans	No untracked holding; no punishment framing
Dean pulled from post	Other dean or trained restorative covers ★	Proactive block pauses temporarily	Rapid Response + Room Lead
Restorative staff member absent	Band room visits route to Room Lead	Other restorative staff split proactive work	CICO essentials and re-entry repair
Counselor absent	Remaining counselor covers crisis across bands	Clinical groups compress or reschedule	Threat/safety response and family communication

VISUAL 3 — DOWN-A-PERSON BACKUP MAP

WHEN THE TEAM IS DOWN...	COVERAGE MOVE	WHAT COMPRESSES	WHAT CANNOT DROP
Down a Dean	Senior/restorative designee assumes a ★ spine post	Some proactive support	Rapid Response, Room Lead, upper-grade lunch coverage
Down a Restorative Team Member	Room Lead absorbs that band's RR visits; other anchors split proactive work	Circles, recognition, lunch bunches	Re-entry, repair, CICO essentials
Down a Counselor	Remaining counselor covers crisis lane for both bands	Clinical groups and non-urgent family meetings	Threat/safety response, safety planning, mandated reporting lane
Multiple absences	Director/Head of School prioritizes safety spine and required support	Most proactive routines pause	Safety, RR, crisis, documentation, re-entry

VISUAL 4 — COVERAGE DECISION LADDER

PRIORITY	DECISION QUESTION	DEFAULT ANSWER
1	Is anyone unsafe?	Cover Rapid Response and Incident Command first.
2	Is the Regulation Room covered?	Assign or backfill Room Lead before expanding proactive work.
3	Are CICO/DBRC and repair loops protected?	Compress them if needed, but do not drop them.
4	Which proactive routine can flex?	Pause the least urgent routine and rebuild it when staffed.
5	Has the loop been closed?	Document the adjustment, repair, and next coverage move before the day ends.

When there is pressure, the team decides in this order: 1) Is anyone unsafe? 2) Is the Regulation Room covered? 3) Are CICO/DBRC and repair loops protected? 4) Which proactive routine can flex and be rebuilt later? This prevents the team from solving the loudest problem while leaving the most important post uncovered.

PART 8

CONTINGENCIES & SAFETY

The culture system must hold when pressure is highest: a fight, a crisis, an unexpected absence, or a coverage gap. Safety is protected first, always. When safety needs rise, proactive routines pause first so the non-negotiable safety and restoration functions remain covered.

— EMERGENCY — THE RESTORATIVE RESPONSE CODE

- **First on scene.** Rapid Response (★) responds immediately; the available Dean or the Director acts as Incident Commander and directs. If it is physical, both deans converge.
- **Backfill chain.** When Rapid Response leaves the floor, the involved student's band anchor becomes acting floor; the Room Lead holds the room; if the Room Lead is also pulled, the next free restorative covers it. Proactive work pauses — nothing safety-critical does.
- **Clinical lane in parallel.** The band counselor handles the de-escalation aftermath, any threat or suicide-ideation assessment, and the safety plan — separate from the physical-safety responders.
- **Pull from a room or recess.** If a student must be removed, Rapid Response plus the band anchor escort them to the Regulation Room's Regulate zone and begin the 3Rs.
- **After.** The band anchor leads repair, the counselor handles clinical follow-up, and the Incident Commander documents and closes the loop.

— DOWN A PERSON — COVERAGE PRIORITY

When the team is short, functions are covered in this order so the most important work never goes uncovered:

- 1** **Safety spine.** Rapid Response + Incident Commander — covered no matter what.
 - 2** **Room Lead** covered next.
 - 3** **CICO / DBRC** compressed, not dropped.
 - 4** **Proactive** circles, lunch bunches, recognition — pause or flex first, then rebuild when staffing returns.
- **Cross-training.** Every restorative staffer is trained to run the Room and Rapid Response; deans can run the room; counselors hold the clinical and crisis lane. A daily coverage card pre-decides who covers what if a specific person is out, so coverage is not improvised under pressure.
 - **Down a dean** → a senior restorative staffer assumes a spine post; proactive routines run with fewer people that day.
 - **Down a restorative** → that band's room visits route to the Room Lead; the other two restorative staff split proactive coverage.
 - **Down a counselor** → the remaining counselor covers crisis for both bands; clinical groups compress.

PART 9

DATA, DOCUMENTATION & IMPROVEMENT

- **What gets tracked:** Repair-conversation completion, CICO data, Regulation Room visits with durations and what worked, recognition reach (who is and is not being recognized), attendance, belonging signals, and movement on the Students-of-Concern list. Connection

and repair are tracked as carefully as incidents because they show whether the Culture Engine is protecting belonging, not only whether behavior occurred.

- **Documentation standard:** Documentation protects memory, equity, follow-through, and repair. Use observable language; avoid labels, diagnoses, and speculation. Enter within the same day (no later than 24 hours). An incident stays open until the repair is completed and logged — that is what closing the loop means.
- **Weekly prevention-first cadence:** The Culture/MTSS meeting opens with prevention leading indicators — belonging, attendance, recognition reach, push-in and circle usage, and the Students-of-Concern review — and only then turns to response data. Every decision is logged with an owner, an action, a due date, and a data source.
- **Equity audit & bias pause:** Review who is referred, recognized, repaired, and excluded by group every cycle. Before any subjective referral — defiance, disrespect, disruption — staff take the bias pause and check whether the same behavior from a different student would draw the same response.

PART 10

TIER & ESCALATION MAP

TIER 1 — UNIVERSAL PREVENTION

Morning Meetings, the Lunch Culture Loop, recognition and Houses, regulation tools, and clearly taught expectations. Owned by teachers with active participation from the Restorative Team and topic contributions from Counselors after the first 90 days of staff onboarding. The goal is that most students experience belonging, skill-building, and support before they need anything more intensive.

TIER 2 — TARGETED

CICO/DBRC, Connection Teams, small SEL and Behavior Skills groups, and the Regulation Room. Run by restorative staff and counselors; the deans own the system and its consistency.

TIER 3 — INTENSIVE

BIPs, FBAs, individualized plans, wraparound and Aspire, and manifestation determinations. Clinical work is led by counselors; decisions are owned by the Director.

MOVEMENT

Students step up or fade down on data against clear entry and exit criteria — never on an adult's frustration. The least intensive effective support is always tried first.

ON ISS

The automatic 'three Regulation Room referrals in a day → ISS' rule is replaced by a Culture-Team decision based on data and an equity pause. If ISS is used at all, it is an exclusionary-coded last resort that follows the restorative sequence — not a Tier 2 entry point. Removal is not the intervention, and a student's place in this community is never the thing taken away.

APPENDIX

SWAP-IN TOOLS

Short, printable tools referenced throughout the handbook. Each is meant to live on a card, clipboard, shared tracker, or staff-facing quick-reference tool.

PERSONAL PAUSE CARD

STOP Pause at the threshold; do not enter mid-reaction.

BREATHE Take two or three slow, exhale-led breaths.

SET THE TONE Soften face and voice to flat-calm; drop the shoulders; slow the pace.

CHECK 'Am I regulated enough to regulate them?' If not, the regulated colleague goes in first.

3RS REGULATION ROOM SCRIPTS

REGULATE · ENTRY *'I'm glad you're here. You don't have to talk. Have some water and take the time you need.'* — minimal words, flat tone, L-stance, sensory tools offered.

RELATE · VALIDATION STEMS *'That makes sense that you felt ____.' / 'Anyone might feel ____ in that moment.'* — validate the feeling without endorsing the behavior.

REASON · RESTORATIVE QUESTIONS What happened? Who was affected, and how? What were you needing? What would make it right? What will you do differently next time?

TAP-IN / TAP-OUT SIGNAL & SCRIPT

TAP-IN · DEFAULT, ~5 MIN Teacher sends the agreed signal; the restorative member arrives and says, *'I've got the class — go ahead.'* The teacher steps to the hallway for a brief, private restorative conversation with the student (about five minutes), then both return.

TAP-OUT · EXCEPTION When a different adult needs to stabilize the moment first, the restorative member takes the student to the Regulation Room and runs the 3Rs while the teacher keeps teaching. The teacher-student repair still returns when regulation makes it possible.

REFERRAL THRESHOLD — CLASSROOM VS. REGULATION ROOM

CLASSROOM-MANAGED Minor, brief, responsive to redirection or an in-class reset.

REGULATION ROOM Dysregulation that exceeds an in-class reset, a safety concern, or a needed repair that cannot happen in the room.

BIAS PAUSE Before any subjective referral (defiance, disrespect, disruption), check whether the same behavior from a different student would draw the same response.

RE-ENTRY PLAN TEMPLATE

PATH Correct → Repair → Rejoin.

RE-ENTRY SENTENCE The student carries it to the teacher: *'I'm ready to rejoin. I'm going to ____, and I've made it right by ____.'*

DAILY COVERAGE CARD

Who is out today · who covers their spine post · who absorbs their band's room visits · which proactive block flexes · crisis lane lead.

COVERAGE BACKUP QUICK REFERENCE

- **Safety spine first:** Rapid Response + Incident Command + Room Lead stay covered before any proactive routine.
- **Clinical lane is separate:** Counselors hold crisis, threat, suicide-ideation, safety planning, Aspire-critical needs, and family/community clinical follow-up.
- **CICO / DBRC compresses, not drops:** if staffing is tight, shorten the touchpoint but preserve the relationship and data loop.
- **Protected reset shifts, not disappears:** urgent safety may move the time, but adult restoration remains part of the operating system.
- **Proactive work flexes first and gets rebuilt:** circles, recognition pushes, and mentoring may pause during safety pressure, then return as soon as coverage stabilizes.

REPAIR-TRACKING LOG FIELDS

Student · date · impact type · matched repair assigned · repair completed (Y/N) · re-entry done · follow-up / pattern flag.

FINAL COMMITMENT

This handbook will shift as we learn. What will not shift: **we prevent what is preventable, we regulate before we reason, and we never take away a student's place in this community.** That is the work.